

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

**GENERAL COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST
OF COOPERATIVE AUDIT OFFICER UNDER COOPERATION DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(MARCH-2026)**

QUESTION BOOKLET

GENERAL ENGLISH

Question
Booklet Series

B

Time Allowed : 3 hours

Maximum Marks : 100

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Immediately after the commencement of the examination, you should check that this question booklet does not have any unprinted or torn or missing pages or items, etc. If so, get it replaced by a complete question booklet of the same series.
2. Write and encode clearly the question booklet series A or B as the case may be in the appropriate place in the OMR Answer Sheet.
3. **Particulars/Details to be filled up in the OMR Answer Sheet should be filled up completely and correctly, OMR Answer Sheet of candidates failing to do so will NOT be evaluated.**
4. This Question Booklet contains *Section- 'A' & 'B'*. *Section - 'A' should be answered only on the Answer Sheet and Section - 'B' should be answered only on OMR Response Sheet provided.*
5. After the examination has concluded, you should hand over the OMR and the Answer Sheet to the Invigilator only. You are permitted to take away with you the Question Booklet.
6. Separate sheets for rough work will be provided in the Examination Hall.
7. There shall be negative marking for all Objective/MCQ type questions
8. For each incorrect answer in the MCQ, one-third (1/3rd) of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted.

SECTION - A (Conventional Type) (34 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the **Answer Sheet** provided.*

Marks for each question is indicated against it.

1. Write a précis of the following passage: (14)

In the ancient world, cities such as Nineveh, Babylon and Alexandria had reached populations of 100,000, and Rome was probably the first to reach a million. While many cities in later centuries matched the size of Rome, the 19th century saw a spurt in urban growth. By 1900 both London and New York surpassed 5 million. Many other world cities grew at similar rates. A key factor was industrialization, which drew vast numbers from country to city.

There was at the same time a big rise in global trade, especially across the Atlantic, with both primary products such as grain and manufactured goods exported in bulk to Europe from the Americas, so that coastal cities such as New York and Buenos Aires grew significantly. There was comparable development - though later and at first on smaller scales - in the Pacific world for cities such as San Francisco, Sydney, Singapore, Tokyo and Hong Kong. Being at the hub of railway networks also encouraged the growth of inland cities such as Chicago. Railways also led to suburbanization, which altered the shape of cities and towns by enabling many of the newly wealthy middle classes to move into leafy outlying suburbs.

The many new factories, usually located in towns and cities, required substantial workforces. Capital cities such as Berlin also grew as government itself became an employer of more and more people. Cities created an increasingly man-made environment, no longer ruled by the rhythms of rural life. This was vividly demonstrated when street lights challenged the dark and sewers replaced the collection of human excrement by cart for use as fertilizer. The symbolic power of cities was expressed when they hosted great displays of technology and power, beginning with London's Great Exhibition of 1851.

Cities also posed serious problems for health and living standards. Slums, poor sanitation and overcrowding encouraged diseases such as cholera and tuberculosis. Many urban 'improvement' schemes were designed to destroy slums where the authorities felt they had lost control. It has been argued that Haussmann's redesigned boulevards in Paris, influential in cities worldwide, were an attempt to create an urban environment that favoured the army over the mob: wider streets were more exposed and harder to barricade. Under Western rule or influence, many non-Western cities also acquired features such as railway stations, boulevards, telegraph buildings and major hotels. Nevertheless, in 1900 the largest urban areas were still concentrated in Europe and North America.

- 2. (a) As a Co-operative Audit Officer, draft a letter to the Registrar of Co-operation Department proposing a training programme for co-operative society staff on proper accounting, auditing, and record-keeping practices. Highlight the benefits of such training for improving financial management and accountability. (10)**

OR

- (b) Write an application as Malsawmzuali for the post of a Social Worker in the non-profit organization KNJ Foundation, addressing the Director, Bethlehem Veng, Aizawl, Mizoram as advertised in *The Zozam Times*, Vol. XVIII, Issue 32 of 6th February 2026.**

3. Read the passage given below carefully and answer the questions that follow:

In barely one generation, we've moved from exulting in the time - saving devices that have so expanded our lives, to trying to get away from them -often, in order to make more time. The more ways we have to connect, the more of us seem desperate to unplug. Like a teenager, we appear to have gone from knowing nothing about the world to knowing too much, all but overnight.

The average person spends at least eight and a half hour a day in front of the screen. The average teenager spends or receives 75 text messages a day. Since luxury, as any economist will tell you, is a function of scarcity, the children of tomorrow will crave nothing more than freedom, if only for a short while, from all the blinking machines, streaming videos and scrolling headlines that leave them feeling empty, and too full all at once. The urgency of slowing down - to find the time and space to think - is nothing new, of course, and wiser souls have always reminded us that the more attention we pay to the moments, the less time and energy we have to place it in some larger context. Even half a century ago, Marshall McLuhan warned, "When things come to you very fast, naturally you lose touch with yourself".

Yet, few of those voices can be heard these days, precisely because 'breaking news' is coming through perpetually on the news channels, and Meena is posting images of her summer vacation and the phone is ringing. We barely have enough time to see how little time we have. And the more that floods in on us, the less of ourselves we have to give to every snippet.

We have more and more ways to communicate, as Thoreau noted, but less and less to say. Partly because we are so busy communicating, and as he might also have said - we are rushing to meet so many deadlines that we hardly register that what we need most are lifelines. So, what should we do? The central paradox of the machines that have made our lives so much brighter,quicker,longer and healthier is that they cannot teach us how to make the best use of them; the information revolution came without Instruction manual. All the data in the world cannot teach us how to sift through data: images don't show us how to process images. The only way to do justice to our screen lives is by summoning exactly the emotional and moral clarity that cannot be found on any screen.

May be that is why more and more people, even if they have no religious commitment, seem to be turning to yoga or meditation, or tai chi; these are not New Age fads so much as ways to connect with that what could be called the wisdom of old age. A series of tests in recent years has shown that after spending time in a quiet rural setting, subjects "exhibit greater attentiveness, stronger memories and generally improved cognition. Their brains become both calmer and sharper". More than that, empathy, as well as deep thought, depends on neural processes that are very "inherently slow". The very ones our high speed lives have little time for.

- (a) According to the author, what is likely to become a scarcity in the future? (2)
- (b) Why does the author say, "We have more and more ways to communicate, but less and less to say?" (2)
- (c) According to the passage, how does a high-speed digital life affect empathy and deep thinking? (2)
- (d) What does the author mean by saying that the "information revolution came without an instruction manual"? (2)
- (e) How does spending time in a quiet rural setting affect people, according to the passage? (2)

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice Questions) (66 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.

*The questions in this Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 8) : Select the most appropriate meaning of the following idioms and phrases:

1. Wrangled over an ass's shadow
(a) quarrel over trifles (b) to quarrel like fools
(c) to fight unnecessary battle (d) to do unnecessary works
2. A wide berth
(a) keep away from (b) publicly condemn
(c) give publicity to (d) not sympathise with
3. Ran in the same groove
(a) promote each other (b) move in harmony
(c) clash with each other (d) move in different directions
4. Carrot and stick policy
(a) fair and foul (b) continuous vigilance
(c) democratic (d) reward and punishment
5. Like a shag on a rock
(a) completely alone (b) completely idle
(c) completely silent (d) completely happy
6. Willing to do something immediately
(a) At sixes and sevens (b) A damp squib
(c) At the drop of a hat (d) A mare's nest
7. To kick the bucket
(a) To die (b) To be lazy
(c) To be angry (d) To be argumentative
8. Between the devil and the deep sea
(a) To be tempted to do evil (b) Between two dangers
(c) To be devoid of feelings and emotions (d) To lash out at someone violently

Direction (Question Nos. 9 - 16) : Complete the following sentences with the most appropriate words.

9. An undercover police has to _____ himself to the changing situation in order to survive.
(a) adapt (b) adopt
(c) adept (d) adorn
10. Mr. Phillips is an _____ man who will get the job done.
(a) unaware (b) ineffective
(c) efficient (d) inappropriate
11. When you enter the office, please mention the _____ of your visit.
(a) process (b) precipitation
(c) purpose (d) whereabouts

12. The younger son of the Czar _____ his father last year.
(a) secluded (b) succeeded
(c) sequestered (d) surpasses
13. My sister is a _____ who reminds me about what is wrong and what is right.
(a) military (b) moralist
(c) fatalist (d) mercenary
14. My father is a _____ who does not like to be around people.
(a) philanthropist (b) philosophist
(c) misanthropist (d) pedestrian
15. The repairman told me that my printer was _____ so he cannot find the spare parts.
(a) obsolete (b) unanimous
(c) pacifist (d) piscivore
16. Mr. Johnson is a _____ as he has abandoned his country and joined the other side.
(a) oppressor (b) panacea
(c) defector (d) palmist

Direction (Question Nos. 17 - 23) : Fill in the blanks with the correct form the verbs given in brackets.

17. We _____ (study) last night, but we went to the concert instead.
(a) must have studied (b) might study
(c) should have studied (d) would study
18. No boy or girl _____ (be) lucky.
(a) is (b) am
(c) are (d) were
19. He advised me, "You had better _____ (leave) now".
(a) Leaving (b) leave
(c) left (d) had left
20. The phone tower _____ (shake) when the worker climbed it this evening.
(a) has shaken (b) shakes
(c) is shaking (d) was shaking
21. Mr. Dasgupta _____ (monitor) this patch of land since 2000.
(a) will monitor (b) will have been monitoring
(c) has been monitoring (d) monitor
22. Gravity _____ (pull) objects towards the Earth.
(a) pulls (b) does pull
(c) pulled (d) has pulled
23. The inmates _____ (fight) when the Chief of Police entered the prison yard.
(a) fight (b) are fighting
(c) were fighting (d) has been fighting

Direction (Question Nos. 24 - 30) : Transform the following sentences as directed without changing the meaning.

24. This is not the best use of your time. (*Change to an Interrogative Sentence*)
- (a) Is this how you use your time?
 - (b) Is this the best use of your time?
 - (c) Will you use your time best?
 - (d) Is this the best time to use this?
25. I wish I were a millionaire (*Change to an Exclamatory Sentence*)
- (a) If I was only a rich man!
 - (b) How to be a millionaire!
 - (c) If only I were a millionaire!
 - (d) If only I could have been a millionaire!
26. I was doubtful whether it was you. (*Change to a Negative Sentence*)
- (a) I was not sure that it was you.
 - (b) I was unsure that it was going to be you.
 - (c) I am rather unsure if it was you.
 - (d) I was very not sure if that was you or not.
27. Martin finished his lesson and put away his textbooks. (*Change to a Simple Sentence*)
- (a) Martin finished his lesson hence he put away his books.
 - (b) Martin finished his lesson however he put away his textbooks.
 - (c) Martin finished his lesson then and there he put his textbooks away.
 - (d) Martin finished his lesson, he put away his textbooks.
28. Search his backpack and you will find the missing wallet. (*Change to a Complex sentence*)
- (a) If you search his backpack, you will find the missing wallet.
 - (b) If you search his bag therefore you will find the missing wallet.
 - (c) If his backpack is searched the missing wallet will probably be there.
 - (d) If people search his backpack wherefore will the missing wallet be found.
29. None can escape death. (*Change to an Affirmative sentence*)
- (a) Some must die.
 - (b) All must die.
 - (c) None must die.
 - (d) Few must die.
30. You are forbidden to drink. (*Change to an Imperative sentence*)
- (a) Don't drink.
 - (b) Please drink.
 - (c) Do drink.
 - (d) Drink instantly.

Direction (Question Nos. 31 -36) : Choose the correct alternative to change the speech.

31. The poor examinee said, "O God take pity on me."
- (a) The poor examinee prayed to God to take pity on him.
 - (b) The poor examinee, invoking God, implored him to take pity on him.
 - (c) The poor examinee exclaimed that God take pity on him.
 - (d) The poor examinee asked God to take pity on him.

32. Jim said, "I work here every day."
(a) Jim said that he worked here yesterday."
(b) Jim said that he worked there everyday."
(c) Jim said that he worked here everyday."
(d) Jim said that he worked everyday."
33. The assistant said, "It has been snowing since this morning".
(a) The assistant says that it has been snowing since that morning.
(b) The assistant said that it had been snowing since that morning.
(c) The assistant said that it has been snowing since this morning.
(d) The assistant said that it was snowing since that morning.
34. Sarah said, "The sun rises in the East".
(a) Sarah said that the sun will rise in the East.
(b) Sarah said that the sun rose in the East.
(c) Sarah said that the sun has risen in the East.
(d) Sarah said that the sun rises in the East.
35. Aragon said that he did not enjoy the movie.
(a) Aragon said, "I have not enjoyed the movie".
(b) Aragon said, "I am not enjoying the movie".
(c) Aragon said, "I did not enjoy the movie".
(d) Aragon said, "I am not enjoyed the movie".
36. The planner said that the next meeting would be on Friday.
(a) The planner said, "The next meeting will be on Friday".
(b) The planner said, "The next meeting would be on Friday".
(c) The planner said, "The next meeting must be on Friday".
(d) The planner says, "The next meeting will be on Friday".

Direction (Question Nos. 37 - 51) : Identify the parts of speech of the underlined words and choose the correct answer from the given alternatives:

37. She expressed her sadness on receiving news of the accident.
(a) Noun (b) Adjective
(c) Verb (d) Preposition
38. You saw the way she looked at the car.
(a) Adjective (b) Verb
(c) Adverb (d) Noun
39. We admired the landscape of the country and decided to return annually.
(a) Adjective (b) Conjunction
(c) Adverb (d) Verb
40. This building will never be given to that man, it is yours.
(a) Adverb (b) Noun
(c) Adjective (d) Pronoun
41. The woman walked through the graveyard to get to her house.
(a) Verb (b) Conjunction
(c) Preposition (d) Adverb

Series - B

42. I rarely eat rice these days as I have to lose some weight.
(a) Adverb (b) Preposition
(c) Adjective (d) Conjunction
43. Moriarty found many shoes under the house.
(a) Adverb (b) Verb
(c) Adjective (d) Preposition
44. The judge made a decision and ruled that the estate be divided among the seven sons.
(a) Conjunction (b) Interjection
(c) Adjective (d) Preposition
45. You might feel despair however there is always hope as long as one is alive.
(a) Conjunction (b) Adverb
(c) Preposition (d) Adjective
46. Harvey wished to meet his estranged parents at the event .
(a) Verb (b) Interjection
(c) Noun (d) Pronoun
47. The boy who stole the watch was caught.
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Relative pronoun (d) Noun
48. He is both scholarly and cultured.
(a) Verb (b) Pronoun
(c) Conjunction (d) Interjection
49. He is a strange person.
(a) Adverb (b) Adjective
(c) Noun (d) Pronoun
50. We waited until she arrived.
(a) Adjective (b) Adverb
(c) Noun (d) Conjunction
51. Mean managers mean nothing to me.
(a) Preposition (b) Verb
(c) Adverb (d) Adjective

Direction (Question Nos. 52 - 66) : Choose the correct alternatives to fill in the blanks:

52. The culprit was beaten _____ a cane.
(a) by (b) with
(c) in (d) at
53. Mr. Walsh saw the gardener sitting _____ his sister.
(a) along (b) besides
(c) beside (d) in
54. The last species of the mammal was born _____ April this year.
(a) at (b) in
(c) by (d) on

55. The head of the department informed her team that she would return _____ a week.
(a) For (b) On
(c) within (d) with
56. Please help me cut the yarn _____ a scissor.
(a) with (b) for
(c) by (d) on
57. I have met with a horrible accident _____ we last met in your house.
(a) while (b) whereas
(c) ever (d) since
58. The band will not play for the ceremony _____ you pay the advance they have charged.
(a) for (b) whether
(c) under (d) unless
59. She tried her best _____ could not win the settlement.
(a) within (b) in
(c) but (d) on
60. She is famous; _____ she is down-to-earth.
(a) so (b) meanwhile
(c) while (d) however
61. Pick up the pace _____ you will be late for church.
(a) only (b) or
(c) but (d) while
62. I have been learning driving _____ eight hours.
(a) since (b) for
(c) from (d) in
63. The property was divided _____ the four sisters.
(a) among (b) for
(c) between (d) in
64. May I sit _____ you two?
(a) among (b) between
(c) across
65. We live _____ the fourth floor.
(a) on (b) in
(c) at (d) by
66. My sister knows French and German _____ Latin.
(a) beside (b) besides
(c) with (d) for